Grayson Iller

Flight Test Engineer Lead, Device Platform

Redwood City, CA | (904) 229-9776 | graysoniller@outlook.com | US Citizen
linkedin.com/in/grayson-iller-a119b2202 | Portfolio | vueniverse.com

SUMMARY

Three years at Skydio validating the controller experience for public safety and national security operators. Since 2022 I have filed 129 UI and UX issues on the controller and mobile app, and 83 are closed. I map critical user journeys and find the places where the interface and the aircraft disagree. Designed and built VUE solo, from Figma to production. Applying to move from validating these interfaces to designing them.

EXPERIENCE

Skydio | Flight Test Engineer Lead, Device Platform | San Mateo, CA | September 2025 to Present

- Test lead for Controller 2 from hardware bring-up in September 2025 through Beta and general availability.
- Found and documented cases where the controller UI showed a drone as on or connected when it was off, unpaired, or out of reach, then worked with engineering to close them.
- Mapped the controller's onboarding, sign-in, and reset flows across first boot, sign-out, blocked, and recovery paths, and proposed a single unified flow in a FigJam flow map.
- Led release validation for a second Controller 2 release program through GA, alongside the commercial release.
- Manage one direct report who owns mobile device platform validation.

Skydio | Flight Test Engineer | June 2023 to September 2025

- Controller and mobile validation across the S2, X2, and X10 platforms.
- Authored the controller test suite in TestRail around the operator's flow rather than by subsystem: unbox and pair, pre-flight, launch, mission, interrupt and recover, return and review.
- On-site at a Bay Area police department for controller radio-interference testing with the wireless and electrical teams. Validated the hardware rework.
- Documented how the in-flight radio-interference alert appears, clears, and dismisses, and raised that an alert firing too often would frustrate public safety operators.

Skydio | Flight Test Intern, UI/Human Factors | May 2022 to August 2022

- Mobile-side flight test: UI/UX feature testing and drone system validation with hardware and software teams. Wrote the mobile in-flight skills test suite.

PROJECTS

VUE (vueniverse.com) | Founder, Designer, Engineer | 2024 to Present

- Fashion intelligence platform that aggregates daily new arrivals from 100+ women's fashion brands into one personalized feed. Live in production with real users and affiliate monetization.
- Designed end to end in Figma and FigJam first, then developed with AI-assisted coding workflows using Claude.
- Removed the sign-up wall after retention data showed visitors who opened a product returned at 50% versus 6% for those who did not; moved auth to the point of intent (first follow or save).
- Ran a design audit that collapsed three auth screens and six button styles into one system: one accent, one type scale, 44 px minimum touch targets, WCAG 2.1 AA contrast.

SKILLS

Design: Critical user journeys, flow mapping, information architecture, interaction design, design systems, Figma and FigJam

Research: Field validation with public safety operators, usability testing

Build: React 18, TypeScript, Tailwind, Supabase, Vercel, AI-assisted development with Claude

Tools: Jira, TestRail, Instabug, Git/GitHub

EDUCATION

Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University | B.S. Human Factors Psychology (HCI focus), Minor in Aerospace Physiology | 2019 to 2023

NCAA Division II Women's Cross Country and Track & Field. FAA Part 107 certified UAV pilot. PADI Open Water Diver. Olympic-distance triathlon finisher.

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS

- Tooker, M., Iller, G., French, J., McGrath, B., & Rupert, A. (2022). Pilot-in-the-loop technology for moon landings. 73rd International Astronautical Congress, IAF/IAA Space Life Sciences Symposium.
- Crichton, C., Delgado, L., Iller, G., Juarez, K., McMandon, A., & Talley, J. (2021). The Link Between Spatial Disorientation in Flight and Mild Hypoxia. Embry-Riddle Student Research Symposium. Lead presenter.